REMARKS

Claim Status

Claims 1-12, 16, 21, 22, 24, 26-28, and 35 are pending, and are subject to a restriction requirement.

Upon entry of the present amendment claim 22 is amended, claims 1-12, 16, 21, 27, 28, and 35 are canceled, without prejudice, and claims 37-47 are added. Support for the claim amendment and new claims may be found throughout the as-filed specification.

Therefore, no new matter is added. Entry of the amendments is respectfully requested.

Upon entry of the present amendment, claims 22, 24, 26, and 37-47 will be pending and presented for examination.

Restriction Requirement

The Examiner has required Restriction under 35 U.S.C. § 121.

Without acknowledging the propriety of the restriction, Applicant hereby elects, without traverse, group II, claims 22, 24, 26, and 37-47. Claims 22, 24, 26, and 37-47 read on the elected group. Applicant expressly reserves the right under 35 U.S.C. § 121 to file one or more divisional applications directed to the non-elected subject matter during the pendency of the instant application.

CONCLUSION

If in the opinion of the Examiner, a telephone conference would expedite the prosecution of the subject application, the Examiner is encouraged to call the undersigned at the number indicated below.

In the event that the U.S. Patent and Trademark Office determines that an extension and/or other relief is required, Applicant petitions for any required relief including extensions of time and authorizes the Commissioner to charge the cost of such petitions and/or other fees due in connection with the filing of this document to Deposit Account **07-0630**.

Respectfully submitted,

March 27, 2026
Date

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